

Pocket

UX Research Document

Empathize · Define · Ideate · AI-Assisted Research

Section 1 — Empathize: User Personas

Seven personas were developed through AI-assisted secondary research, informal conversations, and published data on financial exclusion across five continents. Claude was used to identify gaps in the initial persona set, surfacing gig economy workers and single parents in emerging markets as underrepresented.

Persona 1 — Maya Chen (Primary)

Field	Details
Age	26
Occupation	Software Engineer
Location	Taipei, Taiwan
Income type	Fixed salary
Quote	"I earn well but I have no idea where my money goes every month."

Goals:

- Track monthly spending across food, transport, and entertainment categories
- Save 20% of income toward a travel fund with automatic transfers
- Understand spending patterns with clear visual summaries, not raw transaction lists
- Receive alerts before overspending in a category, not after

Frustrations:

- Bank statements are too detailed and require manual effort to interpret
- Existing apps are overcomplicated with too many setup steps before any value
- No tool shows both spending and savings progress in the same view

UX Insight: Young professionals earn enough to save but lack structured tools that make budgeting feel effortless. Maya drove the chart-first dashboard and AI anomaly detection.

Persona 2 — James Okafor (Primary)

Field	Details
Age	22
Occupation	University Student
Location	Lagos, Nigeria
Income type	Irregular family allowance
Quote	“My student allowance runs out before the end of the month and I never see it coming.”

Goals:

- Stay within a fixed monthly allowance without running out in week three
- Save small amounts toward a specific goal (laptop, trip home)
- Get a simple weekly summary without needing to open the app daily

Frustrations:

- Income arrives in irregular amounts — monthly apps are structurally wrong
- Feels embarrassed about not saving and avoids looking at his balance

UX Insight: Students need budgeting around irregular income and micro-savings goals. James drove the Allowance mode and weekly budget cycle.

Persona 3 — Sarah Mitchell (Secondary)

Field	Details
Age	34
Occupation	Freelance Graphic Designer
Location	London, UK
Income type	Variable freelance
Quote	“My income changes every month so I never know how much I can safely spend.”

Goals:

- Budget dynamically based on variable monthly income without manual reconfiguration
- Set aside a self-employment tax reserve automatically
- Build a three-month emergency fund as a financial safety floor

Frustrations:

- Fixed-budget apps create false alerts when income varies significantly
- Mixes personal and professional expenses unintentionally in current system

UX Insight: Freelancers need dynamic budgeting that adapts monthly and accounts for tax reserves as a built-in category.

Persona 4 — Ravi & Priya Sharma (Secondary)

Field	Details
Ages	38 & 35
Occupations	Accountant & Teacher
Location	Mumbai, India
Income type	Dual salary
Quote	"We agree on big goals but constantly disagree on day-to-day spending."

Goals:

- Manage shared household budget with full transparency
- Save toward holiday and home deposit simultaneously with a priority system

Frustrations:

- No easy way to manage a shared budget without sharing a bank account
- All existing tools are built for individuals; couple features require premium

UX Insight: Couples need shared financial visibility with individual privacy. Shared budget as a free feature is Pocket's single biggest competitive differentiator.

Persona 5 — Eleanor Brooks (Edge Case)

Field	Details
Age	62
Occupation	Retired Teacher
Location	Melbourne, Australia
Income type	Fixed pension
Quote	"I have a fixed pension and I want to make sure my money lasts through retirement."

Goals:

- Manage a fixed pension income with zero overspending
- Understand her savings runway — how long savings will last at current rate
- Use an app that is visually accessible without financial jargon

Frustrations:

- Most finance apps assume users are growing savings, not managing a finite fund
- Small font sizes and complex navigation make apps difficult

UX Insight: Older users managing fixed incomes need clarity tools designed around sustainability. Eleanor drove the savings runway calculator — unique in the market.

Persona 6 — Kevin Adeyemi (Secondary)

Field	Details
Age	29
Occupation	Ride-hailing Driver (Bolt/Uber)
Location	Nairobi, Kenya
Income type	Daily variable gig income
Quote	“Some days are great and some are terrible. I never know what I’ll have by the end of the week.”

Goals:

- Track daily earnings and expenses without a monthly reference point
- Set aside vehicle maintenance costs as a mandatory expense

Frustrations:

- All apps are built around monthly salary cycles — irrelevant to his daily model
- Mobile data costs make heavy-app usage expensive

UX Insight: Kevin drove the roadmap feature for a daily income mode and lightweight offline-first expense entry.

Persona 7 — Fatima Al-Rashid (Secondary)

Field	Details
Age	41
Occupation	Part-time retail + single parent of two
Location	Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Income type	Part-time salary + irregular child support
Quote	“I manage everything on my own and every riyal counts.”

Goals:

- Track every expense with granular clarity — there is no margin for error
- Use an app available in Arabic with culturally appropriate category labels

Frustrations:

- No budgeting app is available in Arabic with a genuinely localised experience
- Child support payments are irregular and no app accounts for this income structure

UX Insight: Fatima drove the right-to-left language support and custom category labelling on the product roadmap.

Section 2 — Journey Maps

Maya Chen — Setting Budget & Tracking First Week

Stage	Action	Thought	Feeling	Opportunity
Discover y	Searches for budgeting app after salary arrives with no savings	I need something quick and visual	Motivated but overwhelmed	Highlight speed and visual dashboard in app store listing
Onboard ing	Sets salary mode, picks 5 categories	Faster than I expected	Relieved	Smart presets by occupation; AI pre-fills common Taipei spending
First Entry	Logs coffee in 2 taps	That was easy — I might keep doing this	Pleasantly surprised	Celebrate first log with micro-animation to build habit
Mid-week	Dashboard shows food at 60%	Good — the chart makes it obvious	Confident	AI projection: 'At this rate food finishes Friday'
Alert	80% entertainment notification	Oh — I didn't realise	Grateful for heads-up	Tap to borrow from another category with one tap
End of Month	Saved 18%; overspent food by 12%	I know exactly where I went wrong	Proud and determined	Month comparison + encouragement message

Section 3 — Problem Statement

People across all income levels and life stages struggle to understand where their money goes and stay within budget — because existing tools are too simplistic, too complex, or structurally designed for a single user type that excludes the majority of the world's population.

Section 4 — Competitive Audit

Feature	Mint	YNAB	Money Manager	Spende e	Pocket
Onboarding time	5–10 min	15–20 min	< 2 min	3–5 min	< 3 min
Variable income support	No	Partial	No	No	Yes — income modes
Shared budget free	No	Paid only	No	Paid only	Yes

Feature	Mint	YNAB	Money Manager	Spendee	Pocket
Visual chart dashboard	Strong	Average	Weak	Strong	Strong
Savings runway calculator	No	No	No	No	Yes
AI-powered insights	No	No	No	No	Yes
Daily/gig income mode	No	No	No	No	Roadmap
Right-to-left language	No	No	No	No	Roadmap

Section 5 — Design Goals & Metrics

Design Goal	Success Metric	AI Contribution
Onboarding under 3 minutes	85% complete without drop-off	AI recommends category presets by income mode
Expense entry < 5 seconds	Average logging time post-testing revision	AI auto-suggests category from description
Savings rate improvement	Users save 10% more in month 2 vs month 1	AI identifies savings opportunities from patterns
Shared budget adoption	40% of couple users activate in first week	Free feature removes only existing barrier
Runway accuracy (pension)	Within 5% of actual over 6 months	AI adjusts for healthcare cost inflation trends